

scholarships—anything that makes them understand that paying for college is mostly going to be their responsibility and that the choice of where they attend can swing their net worth by potentially \$200,000 over a four-year span.

If college is not the right choice, you will still need to acquire the skills, knowledge, and experience that enables you to add value for others, enabling a well-paid career. We'll explore exciting alternatives that can set you on the path to FI without spending time and money for a college degree.

Choosing FI requires starting where you are and determining the right path for you. The remainder of this chapter will help you find the right path to follow on your journey.

Dealing with Student Loans

In an ideal world, this message would reach people as young as high school or earlier and change how we look at school, debt, work, saving, and investing. This would enable more people to get on the path to FI early. Unfortunately, the reality for many people looking to